

The American and French revolutions transformed Western political expectations. If the results were contradictory—the United States emerging as a fully functioning democracy, France destabilized for almost a century—demands for political liberation echoed through the 19th century. These demands took place against a background of Western domination,

supported by rapid industrialization, expanding trade, and population growth. It was an era of unprecedented European global supremacy and imperial expansion on every continent. Yet by 1914, these apparently impregnable powers were poised to tear themselves apart in the world's bloodiest war.

1790



▲ Execution of Marie Antoinette

1793
Louis XVI and Marie Antoinette executed; beginning of "Terror" led by Maximilien Robespierre.

◀ Maximilien Robespierre

1792
Louis XVI overthrown; French republic declared; France declares war on Austria, Prussia, and Piedmont.

1798
Napoleon Bonaparte invades Egypt; French fleet destroyed by British at Battle of the Nile. Ceylon becomes British colony.

1799
Brumaire Coup brings Napoleon to power as first consul. Britain assumes control of south India.

◀ Napoleon's sword from Brumaire Coup

1800

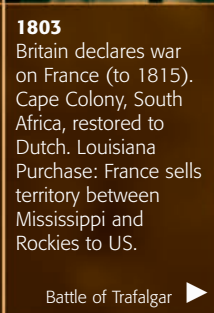


1805
Battle of Trafalgar; Britain defeats Franco-Spanish fleet. Battle of Austerlitz: France defeats Austrians and Russians. Lewis and Clark explore territories of Louisiana Purchase and reach the Pacific.

◀ Napoleon Bonaparte

1806
France defeats Prussia; serfdom abolished in Prussia.

1809
Anti-Spanish uprising in Mexico starts revolts across Latin America. Sweden cedes Finland to Russia.



Battle of Trafalgar ▶



1804
Napoleon assumes title of Emperor of France. Napoleonic Code introduced.

Abolition of slavery in Britain ▶

1810



▲ Treaty of Vienna

1812
Napoleon invades Russia; occupies Moscow, but forced to retreat. Egypt reclaims Mecca and Medina from Ottomans.



1815
Napoleon escapes Elba; defeated at Waterloo; exiled to St. Helena; French monarchy restored. Serbia throws off Ottoman rule. Britain takes control of India.



1813
Battle of the Nations; allies defeat France; British cross into France.

1814
Anti-French allies occupy Paris, Napoleon exiled to Elba. Congress of Vienna to set out future of Europe.

▲ Battle of Maipu

1818
Chilean independence from Spain confirmed by victory in Battle of Maipu. Shaka unites Zulus, South Africa.

1819
US buys Florida from Spain. Colombia gains independence.

1820



1828
Russia acquires Armenia, declares war on Ottomans, takes Varna, Bulgaria. Egypt agrees to withdraw from Greece. Agricultural innovation, such as Morton seed drill, continues.

◀ Simón Bolívar

1821
Greek War of Independence (to 1829) against Ottomans. Venezuela and Mexico achieve independence.

1823–26
First Anglo-Burmese War.

Anglo-Burmese War ▶



1824
Ottomans joined by Egyptians against Greek nationalists. Peru becomes independent from Spain, aided by Simón Bolívar.

1826–28
Russo-Persian War.

1829
Ottomans negotiate Greek and Serbian independence. First passenger railroad in US.

▼ Morton seed drill

